



THERE IS A PARADIGM shift underway in luxury consumption among Indian consumers.

A family from Ahmedabad flies across the Drake Passage for a glimpse of Antarctica before boarding a private Gulfstream aircraft to explore some of South America's most inaccessible destinations.

Wealthy Indian travellers wait up to two years to spend Christmas in Finland's Lapland amid privacy, pristine wilderness and the Northern Lights.

Affluent Indians spend over $1,000 a night on personalised wellness programmes, while luxury car enthusiasts pay lakhs to experience the thrill of driving supercars on frozen lakes in Finland.

Together, these indulgences point to a shift in luxury consumption. Designer handbags, watches and supercars remain coveted, but increasingly, status is also about access to the extraordinary: journeys few have taken, experiences few can buy, and moments that cannot be replicated. As affluent consumers place a greater premium on personalisation, privacy and wellbeing, luxury brands are rethinking what they sell—and how they create value.

The shift is visible globally. According to Bain & Company's Luxury in Transition report, luxury experiences grew 3% in 2025, even as luxury products declined about 1%. "Consumer sentiment towards experiences is outgrowing tangible goods by 1.5x so far in 2026, reflecting a structural and cultural shift from ownership to lived moments," says the report.

The experiential luxury market—luxury hospitality and fine dining—is poised for even faster growth. Euromonitor International says the segment may expand by 20% annually between 2025 and 2030, reaching ₹62,600 crore ($6.59 billion). "Wellness, lifestyle and emotional resonance are emerging as new markers of status, reshaping how brands connect with consumers," says the report.

The shift is evident in spending patterns, too. The Atlas of Affluence 2026 survey by Voice of

THE EXPERIENCE ECONOMY

- CONSUMERS ARE INCREASINGLY WILLING TO PAY A PREMIUM FOR ACCESS, PERSONALISATION, PRIVACY, AND EXPERIENCES THAT CANNOT EASILY BE REPLICATED
- EVEN LUXURY RETAIL, TRADITIONALLY CENTRED ON SELLING EXPENSIVE PRODUCTS, IS EVOLVING INTO AN EXPERIENCE-LED BUSINESS